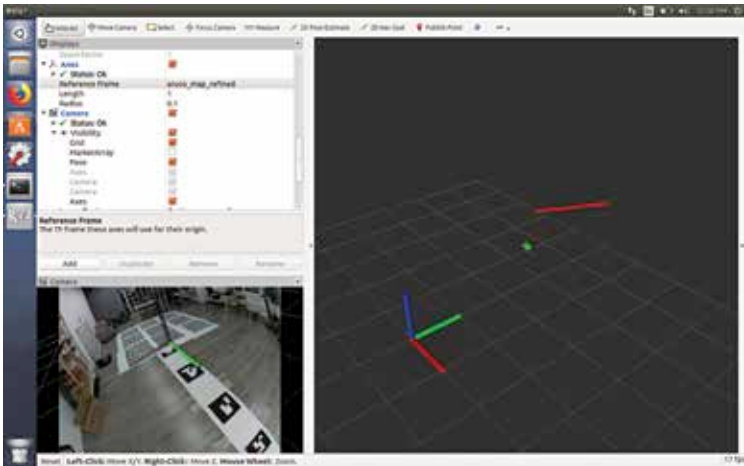


To address this difficulty, Eric and Keenan founded the Stanford Personal Robotics Program in 2006, with the goal of creating a framework that allowed processes to communicate with one another, as well as some tools to help construct code on top of that (slide from Eric and Keenan pitch deck). All of that foundation was planned to be used to write programming for the Personal Robot, a robot they'd also build as a testbed and example to others. They plan to create ten of these robots and provide them to universities so that they may use their framework to develop software.



Rviz and rqt

NOTE: Those familiar with ROS will recognise the antecedents to the ROS-comm libraries, as well as the Rviz, rqt tools, and other components of current ROS distributions. The Personal Robot was also the forerunner to the well-known PR2 robot.

Existing Robot frameworks

The concept of a robotics system like this was not new. Actually, the robotics community had access to a number of other related projects, including Player/Stage, one of the most well-known open-source projects, and URBI, a proprietary system. Even Sony's Open-R technology, which powered the first Aibo robots in 1999, was designed to avoid this difficulty (it's a shame Sony abandoned that project; they could have become the market leaders by now). Sony, ironically, released a new version of the Aibo robot